PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Friday, January 23, 2026

Policy Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Policy Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held virtually and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members:
Vice-Chair Michelle DePass (Committee Chair); and Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller and Stephanie Engelsman

Board Members (Non-Committee): Director Patte Sullivan

Attendees:
Kara Bradshaw – Confidential Executive Assistant; Board Clerk
Emily Courtnage – Senior Legal Counsel
Terry Proctor – Manager, Multimedia Services
Rosanne Powell – Senior Manager, Board of Education
Sharon Toncray – Chief Legal Officer

Call to Order / Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 12:00 pm by Committee Chair Michelle DePass. Attendees introduced themselves. Vice-Chair DePass provided a summary of the agenda.

Public Comment

Time: 12:09 pm

- Blake Goud: Requested the Committee review the policy on school consolidations and closures and capital investments to ensure equitable practices during upcoming consolidation considerations.
- Dr. Effie Greathouse: Outlined a proposal by Safe Indoor Air for Schools Network which included adding three indoor air quality subgoals and revised environmental education goals to the Climate Crisis Response, Climate Justice and Sustainable Practices Policy 3.30.080-P.
- Kylie Menagh-Johnson: In support of the Safe Indoor Air for Schools Network proposed revisions to the Climate Crisis Response, Climate Justice and Sustainable Practices Policy 3.30.080-P.

Policy Review and Potential Revisions/Rescissions of Section 1.00.000-P

Time: 12:05 pm

Sharon Toncray and Emily Courtnage

Staff provided an overview of the considerations used to review and propose revisions to all policies in the 1.00.000-P level of Board Policies. It was noted that the majority of the proposed revisions are discretionary changes intended to clarify and modernize the policies and are not statutory requirements. Committee members heard public comment. There was discussion regarding how to provide feedback on the policy proposals. Committee members will further review the proposed revisions and provide

feedback and questions to staff by February 6, 2026. The Committee will discuss the batch of policy revisions at the next meeting for potential referral to the Board for a First Reading.

There was discussion regarding the legal ramifications of changing the word “shall” to “will” in many of the policies. The Chief Legal Officer stated that, within policy language, the two words hold the same weight, while “will” is more modern and accessible to the general public; however, further legal clarification will be provided at the next meeting.

Other Business

Committee Members discussed revisiting the Climate Crisis Response, Climate Justice and Sustainable Practices Policy 3.30.080-P and the Student Use of Personal Electronic Devices in Schools Policy 8.60.039-P in response to recent public comment heard on the topics. There was general interest in further discussion and informational presentations on the topics. It was noted that the Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee will be hearing a presentation on air quality by the Safe Indoor Air for Schools Network and the Teaching Learning and Enrollment Committee will be hearing a presentation on computers and technology in classrooms. There was discussion regarding the impacts of technology in classrooms.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at 12:44 pm by Committee Chair DePass.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw

Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools